

Startup Funding Proposal
Rosendal Equestrian Experiences (REE)
Professional Investor Version

Date: May 26, 2026

Location: Rosendal, Free State, South Africa

Capital sought: R280,000

1) Executive Summary

Rosendal Equestrian Experiences (REE) is a boutique tourism startup designed to deliver premium, safety-led horseback activities in Rosendal. The strategy is deliberately conservative: launch lean, protect cashflow, build demand through accommodation partnerships, and scale only when metrics support growth.

This proposal is built for investors seeking:

- Clear use-of-funds discipline
- Practical startup scope
- Measured risk controls
- Professional operations in a small market

2) Business Objective

Establish REE as Rosendal's trusted horseback experience provider for visitors seeking memorable, structured countryside activities.

Year-1 objectives

- Reach stable weekend booking cadence
- Achieve positive operational consistency
- Build repeat and referral demand from partner properties
- Maintain strict safety and welfare compliance

3) Market Context and Fit

Rosendal is a small-town destination; therefore REE is modeled around visitor flow rather than local resident volume.

Demand sources

1. Weekend tourists
2. Guests already staying in Rosendal accommodations
3. Family day-trippers from nearby towns

Why the model fits

- Activities complement accommodation stays
- Outdoor experiences align with Rosendal's countryside identity
- The product can run at small scale with controlled costs

4) Product Portfolio

Launch scope (first 6 months)

- Scenic Trail Ride (60 min)
- Sunset Signature Ride (75?90 min)
- Pony Discovery Ride (10?15 min)
- Private Couple Experience (pre-booked)

The initial portfolio is intentionally compact for quality and cost control.

5) Pricing Strategy (Reasonable and Recent)

Recommended launch pricing

- Pony Discovery: R120?R180
- Scenic Trail (60 min): R380?R520 per person
- Sunset Signature: R550?R750 per person
- Private Couple Experience: R1,300?R1,900 per booking

Pricing logic

- Maintain accessibility for startup adoption
- Protect contribution margins per product
- Use controlled adjustments based on occupancy and conversion data

6) Funding Ask and Allocation

Total funding requested: R280,000

Allocation framework

- 28% safety gear, tack, setup
- 20% horse care reserve
- 15% insurance and compliance
- 15% marketing + content + booking setup
- 12% working capital buffer
- 10% route/site readiness

This capital level is sufficient to launch professionally without overcapitalizing a small-market startup.

7) Operating Model

Operating window

- Fridays to Sundays
- Public holidays
- Pre-booking priority to reduce no-show and idle costs

Cost-control principles

- Keep fixed payroll lean
- Use demand-aligned scheduling
- Track per-product performance weekly

Revenue model

Revenue = booked slots product price + premium add-ons

8) Go-to-Market Plan

Primary channel: Accommodation partners

- Formal referral relationships with local hosts
- Simple booking/referral workflow
- Reliable guest handling and communication

Secondary channels

- WhatsApp direct booking
- Google Business Profile
- Instagram/Facebook content for discovery

Conversion priorities

- Fast response time
- Booking clarity (time, what to bring, policy)
- Consistent guest experience and review capture

9) Safety, Compliance, Welfare

REE commits to non-negotiable operating standards:

- Indemnity and consent forms
- Rider suitability screening
- Mandatory safety briefings
- Incident response protocol
- Public liability insurance
- Horse care logs and workload controls
- Weather cancellation procedures

These controls are essential for investor confidence and sustainable operation.

10) Risk Management

Key risks and mitigations

1. Weather disruption

Mitigation: reschedule policy and weather-buffered calendar.

2. Demand variability

Mitigation: partner-led funnel and flexible staffing.

3. Safety incidents

Mitigation: SOP adherence, training, documentation, insurance.

4. Early cashflow pressure

Mitigation: conservative cost structure and weekly cash tracking.

11) Milestone Plan (12 Months)

Months 1-2

- Finalize legal/compliance pack
- Onboard launch partners
- Soft-launch with limited slot inventory

Months 3-6

- Stabilize booking cadence
- Evaluate occupancy and product contribution margins
- Optimize pricing only where justified by data

Months 7-12

- Improve repeat booking rates
- Launch one premium add-on if metrics support it
- Prepare a year-2 growth memo for investors

12) Investor Reporting Commitment

REE will provide:

- Monthly summary updates
- Quarterly performance dashboards
- Transparent use-of-funds tracking
- Risk and incident reporting protocol

13) Conclusion

REE is a premium-leaning but practical startup concept built for Rosendal's market reality. The opportunity is not high-volume scale in year one; it is disciplined execution, strong service quality, controlled risk, and evidence-based growth.

For investors, this translates to a manageable capital entry point with a professional operating framework and a clear path to responsible expansion.